

VOCABULARY BUILDER

The Power of Creativity at Work – Key Words and Phrases • Week 6 • Level A

The words and phrases below appear in the article *The Power of Creativity at Work*. Study the table carefully, then complete the gap-fill exercise in Part 2.

PART 1 – VOCABULARY TABLE

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
creativity	the ability to produce new, original ideas and find imaginative solutions	<i>Employers increasingly value creativity as one of the most important workplace skills.</i>
brainstorm	to generate many ideas freely in a group without immediate criticism or judgement	<i>The team held a brainstorm session and came up with over thirty new product ideas.</i>
problem-solving	the process of finding solutions to difficult or complex challenges	<i>Strong problem-solving skills allow workers to handle unexpected challenges confidently.</i>
teamwork	the ability to work effectively and cooperatively with other people	<i>Good teamwork means trusting your colleagues and making use of everyone's strengths.</i>
feedback	information or opinions given about someone's work to help them improve	<i>She used the critical feedback from her manager to make significant improvements to the report.</i>
initiative	the ability to assess a situation independently and take action without being told	<i>Taking initiative — acting without waiting to be asked — is one of the most valued qualities at work.</i>
delegate	to give tasks or responsibilities to another person, usually someone junior	<i>A good manager knows how to delegate effectively rather than trying to do everything alone.</i>
time management	the ability to organise and use your time efficiently to complete tasks	<i>Poor time management is one of the most common reasons people miss important deadlines.</i>
multitask	to do several different tasks or activities at the same time	<i>Running a small business means you have to multitask — handling sales, finance, and marketing at once.</i>
burnout	a state of complete physical and mental exhaustion caused by long-term overwork	<i>She took a month off after suffering from burnout — she had been working twelve-hour days for a year.</i>
negotiate	to discuss something with others in order to reach a mutually acceptable agreement	<i>The two departments had to negotiate a compromise over how to share the limited budget.</i>
compromise	an agreement in which both sides accept less than they originally wanted	<i>Finding a compromise is often better than letting a conflict damage the whole team's performance.</i>

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
conflict	a serious disagreement or argument between people with different views or needs	<i>Workplace conflict is normal — what matters is how you choose to handle it.</i>
diversity	the presence of a wide range of different backgrounds, perspectives, and experiences	<i>Research shows that diversity in teams leads to more creative and effective problem-solving.</i>
inclusive	welcoming and supportive of all people, regardless of background or identity	<i>An inclusive workplace makes every employee feel valued, heard, and able to contribute fully.</i>
mentor	an experienced person who guides, advises, and supports someone less experienced	<i>Her mentor helped her navigate the challenges of her first management role with confidence.</i>
prototype	an early working version of a product, made for testing before the final design	<i>The engineers built a prototype of the device and tested it with real users before production.</i>
launch	to introduce a new product, service, or business to the public for the first time	<i>The startup plans to launch its app in three countries simultaneously next spring.</i>
target	a specific group of people or customers that a product or campaign is aimed at	<i>The company's target is young professionals aged 25 to 35 who work in urban areas.</i>
profit	the money a business earns after all its costs and expenses have been paid	<i>The new product line became profitable within six months of its launch.</i>
loss	the amount of money a business spends more than it earns in a given period	<i>The company made a loss in its first year, but turned a profit by the end of year two.</i>
investment	money put into a business or project with the expectation of a future return	<i>The founders needed significant investment to develop the technology before launch.</i>
brand	the identity, values, and image that a company presents to its customers	<i>Building a strong brand takes years, but it is essential for long-term customer loyalty.</i>
strategy	a plan of action designed to achieve a long-term goal	<i>Before launching, the team spent three months developing a clear go-to-market strategy.</i>

PART 2 – GAP-FILL EXERCISE

Complete the sentences using the correct word or phrase from the word bank below. You may need to change the form of the word. Some sentences need more than one answer.

WORD BANK

creativity	brainstorm	problem-solving	teamwork
feedback	initiative	delegate	time management
multitask	burnout	negotiate	compromise
conflict	diversity	inclusive	mentor
prototype	launch	target	profit
loss	investment	brand	strategy

1	Strong _____ and _____ are two of the most valued qualities in any workplace — employers need people who can think and work well with others.
2	The team decided to _____ ideas freely before choosing the best one — it's always better to generate too many options than too few.
3	She showed real _____ by spotting a problem and fixing it before her manager even noticed, without being asked to do so.
4	He learned to _____ effectively — trusting his team with tasks rather than trying to do everything himself.
5	Running your own business means you have to _____ constantly, but without good _____ you will quickly fall behind on everything.
6	She suffered from _____ after months of overworking — a reminder that rest is not a luxury but a professional necessity.
7	When the two departments disagreed, they sat down to _____ and eventually reached a _____ that both sides could accept.
8	The company worked hard to become more _____ and increase _____ across all levels — the results showed in their team's _____ and innovation.
9	Her _____ gave her honest, regular _____ that helped her grow faster than she would have done on her own.
10	They built a _____ of the product and tested it with real customers before spending money on full production.
11	Before they could _____ the product, the team needed to identify their _____ customer and develop a clear _____.
12	The business made a _____ in its first year, but attracted strong _____ from two partners, and turned a _____ by month eighteen.
13	A powerful _____ is built over years — it tells customers who you are, what you believe in, and why they should trust you.

14

When _____ arises at work, the worst thing you can do is ignore it — address it early, calmly, and professionally.

15

She joined the company's _____ programme as a junior and, five years later, became a _____ herself — guiding the next generation of new hires.

Write your answers here:

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
4. _____	5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____	9. _____
10. _____	11. _____	12. _____
13. _____	14. _____	15. _____